

August 20, 2026

Ambetter from Absolute Total Care  
Provider Appeals Department

**RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Morgan Gislason (MRN MUSC1901974), Claim MUSC-9AF8-2**

|                          |                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Patient</b>           | Morgan Gislason (DOB 2007-12-15)                                                                            |
| <b>MRN</b>               | MUSC1901974                                                                                                 |
| <b>Member ID / Group</b> | AMB513828945 / GRP-47184                                                                                    |
| <b>Claim number</b>      | MUSC-9AF8-2                                                                                                 |
| <b>Date of service</b>   | 2026-05-08                                                                                                  |
| <b>Procedure billed</b>  | CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity                               |
| <b>Primary diagnosis</b> | J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified                                                      |
| <b>Denied amount</b>     | \$494.98                                                                                                    |
| <b>Denial code</b>       | CARC 204 / RARC N130 — This service/equipment/drug is not covered under the patient's current benefit plan. |
| <b>Appeal deadline</b>   | 2026-09-18                                                                                                  |

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

**SUMMARY OF APPEAL**

MUSC Health is submitting this formal reconsideration appeal on behalf of patient Morgan Gislason (MRN: MUSC1901974, Member ID: AMB513828945) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-9AF8-2 for services rendered on May 8, 2026, at MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center. The claim was denied on June 20, 2026, under CARC 204 ("This service/equipment/drug is not covered under the patient's current benefit plan") and RARC N130 ("Consult plan benefit documents/guidelines for information about restrictions for this service"), with the payer remark stating: "Service is excluded under the member's plan benefit document." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this determination and requests full reversal and payment of the claim.

**CLINICAL BACKGROUND**

Morgan Gislason is an 18-year-old female patient with an active history of perennial allergic rhinitis and a documented acute upper respiratory infection (J06.9) at the time of the May 8, 2026 encounter. She was seen as an established outpatient patient by Elena V. Castellanos, MD (NPI 1881726354) at the on-campus outpatient hospital facility. The visit was coded as CPT 99214, representing an office or outpatient visit for an established patient requiring moderate medical decision-making. The patient's active condition of perennial allergic rhinitis, combined with the presenting acute upper respiratory infection, is consistent with the level of evaluation and management documented and billed. Ms. Gislason's coverage under the Ambetter from Absolute Total Care PPO plan (Group GRP-47184) was active and continuous from January 1, 2024, through the date of service.

## **BASIS FOR APPEAL**

The denial characterizes CPT 99214 as a non-covered or excluded service under the member's benefit plan. MUSC Health respectfully submits that this determination is inconsistent with standard Marketplace plan benefit structures and the nature of the service provided. CPT 99214 is a standard evaluation and management code representing a medically necessary outpatient visit for an established patient. Evaluation and management services for acute illness are a foundational covered benefit under Affordable Care Act-compliant Marketplace plans, which are required to cover essential health benefits including ambulatory patient services and treatment of illness. A blanket exclusion of a routine, medically necessary office visit for an acute upper respiratory infection in an established patient with active comorbid conditions would be inconsistent with these requirements.

Furthermore, the payer's denial does not identify any specific plan exclusion language that would apply to this service, nor does it indicate that a coverage determination was made on clinical grounds. The denial appears to reflect either a claims processing error or a misapplication of the plan's benefit document to this service. MUSC Health requests that Ambetter from Absolute Total Care conduct a thorough review of the applicable benefit language and confirm whether a specific, articulable exclusion exists that would preclude coverage of a standard established-patient evaluation and management visit for acute illness. If such an exclusion exists, we respectfully request that it be cited in full in the reconsideration response so that it may be further evaluated.

## **REQUESTED ACTION**

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Ambetter from Absolute Total Care reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-9AF8-2 and reprocess the claim for payment in accordance with the contracted allowed amount of \$223.80 and the applicable member cost-sharing obligations. Should additional clinical documentation, operative notes, or medical records be required to support this reconsideration, MUSC Health will provide them promptly upon request. This appeal is submitted within the reconsideration deadline of September 18, 2026, through the secure provider portal as directed. We appreciate the plan's timely review of this matter and remain available to discuss any questions.

Respectfully submitted,

**Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC**

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## **Enclosures**

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record